OVERSEAS NEWSLETTER

Issued Monday 4th March 2019

NEW PRESIDENT FOR THE LEGION

The Royal British Legion is pleased to confirm that after a meeting of the Board of Trustees held on 21 February, Lieutenant General James Bashall CB CBE will be appointed as the next National President.

Lieutenant General Bashall will take up his appointment upon the completion of Annual Conference 2019, on Sunday 19 May 2019

Please welcome Lieutenant General Bashall, and his wife, Sarah-Lucie, to The Royal British Legion.



MSO News

District Conferences

In January I was invited to attend District Spain North and District Spain South Annual Conferences. It was great to meet up with so many members and to hear about the good work that the Districts are doing.

Consolidated Payments

Is your branch paying bulk payments by cheque?

Have you considered paying by bank transfer? memberships are usually processed within 48 hours of you sending me the paperwork and any issues can be sorted out much quicker.

Office 365

Overseas Branches continue to embrace using O365 we have a really high amount of Branches that use it on a regular basis. Many Branches are finding Yammer very good as it gives them the opportunity to talk to branches around the world. Please contact me if your Branch Committee wish to start using it.

Lapsed Members

If you have a lapsed member that wishes to re-join or a member that does not appear on your branch listings, please speak to me before sending any payments for them. This will ensure that they are reinstated and the payment allocated correctly

Poppy Appeal

As you may be aware, last year, Vanessa Dean who was the Poppy Appeal contact for Overseas Branches for many years has moved on to a different role within the Legion.

The Overseas Branches have now been split between a team of 6 people. If you do not know who your contact is please let me know.

Overseas Forum

This years Overseas Forum will be held on Friday May 17th at the Annual Conference in Bournemouth

Due to room bookings there will be no Morning session but there will be an open question and answer session directly after the Forum. Details will be sent out shortly

Branch Committees

Please remember that if a member leaves their role or you have a new member join the committee, you need to let me know.

Also please let me know if someone changes their email address

If I don't have the correct contact details for your Committee you may miss out on vital information that I send to branches.

BOB CHAMBERS—MEMBERSHIP COUNCIL REP

Dear Members,

Looking back on 2018 it certainly was a remarkable year for Remembrance, culminating in the celebration of GP90, the centenary of WWI.

So what has 2019 in store for us?

To start with there's the Annual Conference in Bournemouth which this year is most important for a number of reasons.
Not least as we will see a new National President, a new National Chairman and Vice Chairman, as well as many new faces on both the Board of Trustees and the Membership Council.

In the coming weeks all Branches will be receiving or have received the voting papers for the positions of Chairman, Vice Chairman and Board of Trustees. All those standing for election will have their CVs included with the papers. This is another opportunity for your Branch to contribute to the election of the leadership of next 3 years of the RBL – use your vote and get it in on time. It is another step in ensuring that Overseas Branches will not be forgotten

Also at Conference, the motion for the amendments to the Royal Charter is an important one for all of us as the Membership. It will define the future of the way we run and work within this organization.

I am pleased to say that once again there will be an Overseas Forum at the start of the Conference. I know that many of you are thinking of attending. Be there if you can!

Then in June, there's the events in Normandy to mark the 75th anniversary of the beginning of the Liberation of Europe.
The ferry crossing the Channel carrying numerous veterans to the coast of Normandy for the celebration of the D-Day landings will surely be the highlight of the year for many.
Bob Chambers
Overseas Representative
Membership Council



Tom Shepherd

This is just a reminder to be vigilant when it comes to Spam emails. Most spam will be detected by the Office 365 and moved into your junk folder but the golden rule is if you are unsure of the sender, don't click any links in the email and you can even go as far as to just delete the email without opening it.

By default if the system sees your account sending out bulk emails to many addresses in a short amount of time it may trigger the spam filter and temporarily block your account. If this happens, and the email was a legitimate one please get in contact with me by email or through your MSO.

Here are a few standard tips to remember:

1. **Limit the places where you post your e-mail address** Please don't use your RBL.community email address for personal use like signing up to a website or online service e.g. shopping, chatrooms etc. This could then be used to add you to a spamming mailing list.

Don't reply to spam Never reply to an e-mail message — not even to unsubscribe from a mailing list — unless you know and trust the sender, such as when the e-mail message comes from a service, an online store, or newsletter that you have signed up with. Answering spam just confirms to the spammer that your e-mail address is an active one.

If a company uses e-mail messages to ask for personal information, don't respond by sending a message Most legitimate companies will not ask for personal information to be sent in e-mail. Be suspicious if they do. Such a request could be a spoofed e-mail message disguised to look like a legitimate one. This tactic is known as *phishing*. If the possible spam appears to be sent by a company that you do business with — for example, your credit card company — then call the company to verify that they sent it, but don't use any phone number that is provided in the e-mail. Instead, use a number that you find by using other means, such as directory assistance, a statement, or a bill. If the request is a legitimate one, the company's customer service representative should be able to assist you. The Junk E-mail Filter also includes phishing protection to help identify and disable suspicious messages.

Don't contribute to a charity in response to a request sent in e-mail Unfortunately, some spammers prey on your goodwill. If you receive an e-mail appeal from a charity, treat it as spam. If the charity is one that you want to support, locate their telephone number or Web site to find out how you can make a contribution.

Don't forward chain e-mail messages Besides increasing overall e-mail volume, by forwarding a chain e-mail message you might be furthering a hoax — and meanwhile, you lose control over who sees your e-mail address.

Don't open emails in your Junk folder Unless you completely trust the source of the email please don't open emails in the junk folder. The system will automatically delete these after 15 days.

Thank you,

Tom Shepherd

Membership IT Systems Officer

Chonburi Branch

"Whilst as a branch we are always busy during Remembrancetide here in Thailand we also have a second Poppy Appeal period in February, February 3rd being Thai Poppy Day where Thai people remember their Veterans from Korea, Vietnam and present day conflicts.

We have always had a close relationship with the Thai Veterans Organisation and whilst we do not support them financially we do support those who do and many of our members play in a golf tournament that raises funds for them, we also attend the Thai veterans Day Parade where we are hosted to Lunch and invited to march in the Parade, does anyone know what "Squad Halt" is in Thai!!!"

We also visited the Royal Thai Marine Corp depot where we met the Commandant and his senior staff.



Branch Chairman Bob Mann receives a gift from the Royal Thai Marine Commandant



Meeting Staff at the Royal Thai Marine depot



At least the Standard Bearer was in step, we were all given Thai Veterans Hats

Sao Paulo Branch

REMEMBRANCE DAY SERVICE

The annual Remembrance Day Service was held at 10 am on Sunday, November 11th at St. Paul's Anglican Cathedral and was attended by over 370 people. This year being the centenary of the end of the First World War the Royal British Legion offered a special Thank You to all who served, sacrificed and changed our world.

Our service was focused on this and the 33 people who participated in this conflict and who are remembered on our memorial plaque at the cathedral.

As usual, the Commonwealth countries, whose soldiers, sailors and airmen, travelled great distances from relatively safe home countries, together with those brave volunteers from the community in Brazil who did the same, were well represented at the service along with First World War allies such as France, Belgium and the USA.We remember the sacrifice made by the thousands of British and Commonwealth service people who have died in the subsequent conflicts that have taken place since the First World War including of course the Second World War and the allied nations from this conflict including Holland, France, Belgium, Brazil (FEB and FAB) and the USA were also represented at the service.









The musical support this year was from the choir of St Nicholas School and helped us to make the service an even more moving service.

We had a collection for the Poppy Appeal and I would like to thank everyone who contributed towards the poppy sales either before the service via the schools, the Brazilian British Centre, remotely from other locations or British organisations and at the service on the day



The Cathedral technical staff organised the recording of the service and if you did not make it to the service on the day or if you would like to watch it again you can do so via the link below:

https://livestream.com/catedralanglicana/events/1811322/videos/183404829

Following the service we had the normal reception. The reception was also very well attended and we had a couple of special events:

We organised a special First World War display that was set up for the reception after the Remembrance Day Service. This included personal items connected with some of the people whose names are mentioned on the memorial plaque. One very special item was the 1914 wooden cross of an unknown soldier which has now been donated to the RBL by Bishop Roger Bird.



Adriano S. Baumgartner joined us to talk about the Brazilian Air Force Awards that were made last year to the family of Captain Gordon Fox Rule, DFC, CdG* (Brazilian's Greatest WW1 Ace, about whom Adriano has published a book) and this year to the family of W/Cdr Cosme Lockwood Gomm, DSO, DFC who is remembered on the Second World War memorial plaque at the cathedral. Adriano has been very involved with both these projects and is working on various other projects about the RAF including a biography of W/Cdr Cosme Lockwood Gomm, DSO, and DFC.

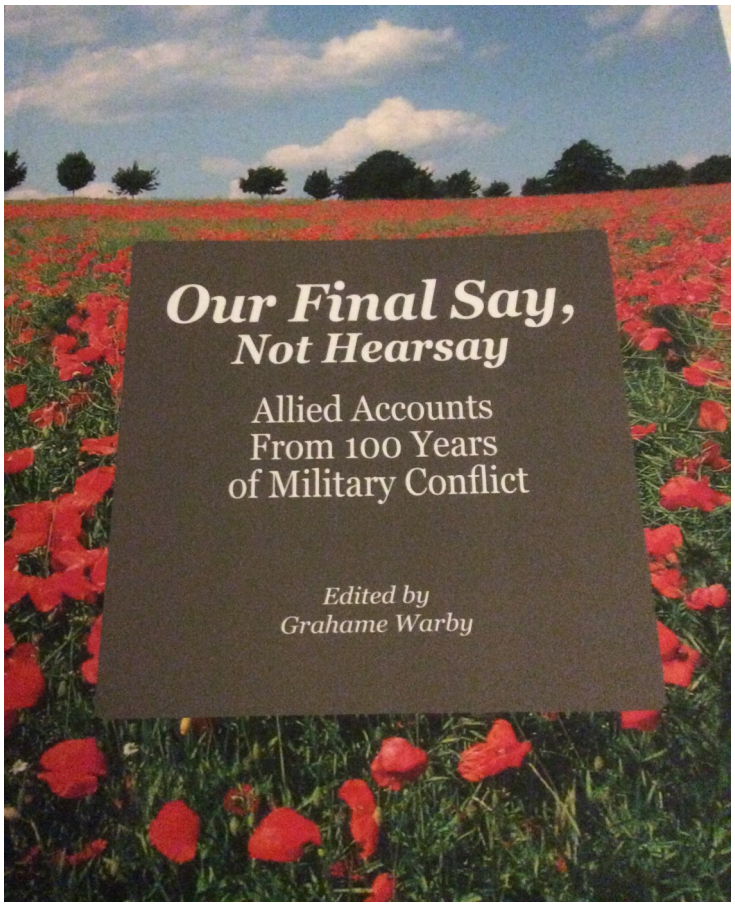
We were joined by the Associação dos Ex-combatentes da FEB along with one of their World War 2 veterans and the President of this association explained a little about what they do.



Either side of the weekend we participated in the French Armistice service to remember the centenary of the end of the First World War at the Lycée Pasteur on the 9th of November and a very poignant Remembrance ceremony and wreath laying at St Pauls School on the 12th of November.

Paul McMahon
President
Royal British Legion - Sao Paulo Branch

PARIS BRANCH



In 2014 the RBL Paris Branch produced a book, “Our Say, Not Hearsay”.

They have now produced a second book of members accounts and those of family and friends from both World Wars and subsequent conflicts. All are true stories.

Also included in the book are poems from school children who took part in the Paris Branch Remembrance project.

Both books can be purchased from Amazon.co.uk or from Janet Warby at ja-netwarby@yahoo.com

HOLLAND BRANCH

75th Commemoration of the Battle of Arnhem: Come and join us

Have you ever considered a visit to the Netherlands but are wondering when would be a good moment? A perfect time to visit would be in September 2019. The Royal British Legion Holland Branch is looking forward to meeting you.

RBL Holland Branch will be present

Every year in September the Dutch people pay tribute to the commitment and dedication of allied soldiers during the Battle of Arnhem. There are several events to commemorate the Battle of Arnhem with impressive/moving remembrance services in Arnhem, Oosterbeek, Driel, Ede and Renkum. The Holland Branch will participate during several events. For example by raising money for the poppy appeal and our standard bearers and wreath layers will have the honour of taking part in the service at the CWGC Arnhem-Oosterbeek War Cemetery.



2019: Bigger than ever

The Arnhem Commemoration in September 2019 promises to be bigger than ever. It will be the 75th anniversary and there is a rumour of the presence of Dutch/British royalty.

The Royal British Legion Holland Branch will be present at all of the following events/services:

We are looking forward to meeting members and supporters of other branches. Are we going to see you?

Saturday 07-09-2019	Airborne Wandeltocht Arnhem-Oosterbeek War Cemetary, Van Limburg Stirumweg 28, 6861 WL Oosterbeek Our branch will be present with our information stall to raise funds for the Poppy Appeal and awareness of The Legion.
Sunday 15-09-2019	Bridge to Bridge Run Marktplein 1, 6823 HD Arnhem Our branch will be present with our information stall to raise funds for the Poppy Appeal and awareness of The Legion.
Monday 16-09-2019	Wreath laying Airborne monument The Needle Utrechtseweg Oosterbeek, opposite the Hartenstein, Airborne Museum Our Branch & standard bearer(s) will be present
Monday 16-09-2019	Wreath laying Airborne Monument in Heelsum Our Branch & standard bearer(s) will be present

Friday 20-09-2019	Renkum Airborne Bennekomseweg/*Telefoonweg in Renkum* Our branch will be present with our information stall to raise funds for the Poppy Appeal and awareness of The Legion.and organise the service of Commemoration at the new monument.
20-09-2019	Branch & Regimental Standards march Over the John Frost Bridge with the Massed Pipes & Drums to Airborne Square in Arnhem followed by a wreath laying ceremony.
Saturday 21-09-2019 Sunday 22-09-2019	Parachute Drop on Ginkelse Heide Our branch will be present with our information stall to raise funds for the Poppy Appeal and awareness of The Legion.. Our standard bearer(s) will be present for the Service 75th Anniversary of the Battle of Arnhem with Service of Commemoration and wreath laying at the CWGC Arnhem Oosterbeek War Cemetery in Oosterbeek for the main Service of Remembrance. Van Limburg Stirumweg 28, 6861 WL Oosterbeek Our Branch & standard bearer(s) will be present

We are looking forward to meeting members and supporters of other branches. Are we going to see you?

Looking back at September 2018 with pride

"On the 22nd of September 2018, our Branch once again was present at the 'Airborne Drop' event near Arnhem to commemorate Operation Market Garden and remember and pay tribute to all those who fought in that campaign.

Two new Monuments dedicated

Our Branch was very much in the spotlight on the 21st September 2018 as we organised the unveiling and dedication of 2 new monuments in the locality.

Both of which involved our Padre, 4 x Standard Bearers, A Trumpeter, Bagpiper, solo singer and Treasurer/Poppy Appeal Organiser together with several thousand local folk as spectators.

Firstly, on Renkum Heath with a granite pillar to mark the first para drop of Operation Market Garden on the 17th September 1944. Paid for by a collection from the village.



And later on the same day a stone to mark the shooting down of a Dakota FZ626 whilst dropping supplies to the North of Arnhem on the 19th September 1944. This was paid for by a local individual.



We thank them all

The 74th year anniversary event saw a bumper crowd of 40,000 turn out to watch parachute jumps made from vintage and current aircraft by 600 airborne troops from the UK, the Netherlands, Poland, Belgium, Germany, France and the US. It all took place over Ginkelse Heide, about 10 miles from Arnhem itself, and many veterans were in attendance, medals proudly on display. As is the norm here they were treated as very honoured guests, we thank them all, and those who are sadly no longer with us.

Enthusiastic team of volunteers

Other attractions included vintage vehicles, militaria and various stalls as well as many of the visitors parading in period uniform and clothes. Not to forget us of course, a team of hardy and enthusiastic volunteers both British and Dutch, intent on raising as much money as possible, but none more enthusiastically than 10 year old Victoria, new youth member and daughter of our Branch liaison officer. Her non-stop effort and willingness to assist in any way she could, put most of us to shame. She was there with a smile, on hand to help, cajole and charm the customers, in addition to keeping us all on our toes.



Say hello to our youth member Victoria

Victoria worked her socks off for us on the day, in addition to her laying a wreath of poppies at a ceremony in the small city of Venray. She contributed immensely to what was ultimately a hugely successful and worthwhile event for Holland Branch, spoiled only at the very end by a sudden and very heavy cloudburst with a vicious wind that soaked us all to the skin whilst we were packing away at the close of proceedings.

All in all a marvellous time was had by everyone, tarnished slightly at the end by the icy rain and accompanying wind, I hope these photographs will give you a little flavour of the day. Maybe we'll see you later this year, I'm sure Victoria will be pleased to say 'hello'.

Written by member Peter Thompson, RBL Holland Branch

HONG KONG & CHINA BRANCH

Dramatic Increase in Membership of Hong Kong & China Branch)

After the departure of British Forces from Hong Kong on 30th June 1997, RBL (HK & China Branch) joined hands with the Hong Kong Ex-Servicemen's Association (HKESA) to organise the Remembrance Sunday parade at the Cenotaph in Central of Hong Kong. The two organisations have been running this most important remembrance ceremony for the community together ever since. However, the two organisations return to their individual daily routine for most of the year.

RBL (HK & China) is the oldest veteran's organisation in Hong Kong, first registered as a charity in Hong Kong in 1951, fulfilling its remit under the terms of the RBL Charter. In contrast, the HKESA was officially formed only in 1997, three months before the British Military Garrison ceased to exist. The HKESA embraced and amalgamated a number of existing organisations in Hong Kong: The World War II Veterans Association; The Naval Local Enlisted Personnel (Hoi Luen) and the Hong Kong Soldiers' Association. The idea was to bring all Chinese former servicemen under one umbrella association, so the HKESA was formed.

What makes Hong Kong's ex-serviceman's situation unique is that, from 1997, the clock stopped leaving a substantial ex-servicemen's population in Hong Kong. Apart from a small but steady stream of new British and Gurkha ex-servicemen, there is no new blood, so effectively numbers are slowly dwindling and members only getting older. It was felt essential to make the most of what we have and recognizing that the aims of the RBL and the HKESA are very similar, it was decided in early 2018 to examine amalgamation options in order to maximize the offering to all members employing our combined resources and know-how. Members were motivated by the prospects that would be brought after amalgamation meaning that membership of the remodeled Branch has more than doubled by the end of 2018, and it is anticipated that more applications are on their way.

As the result of the joint membership, the two clubhouses are now much better used and better equipped, and the welfare of members and their families are effectively dealt with by more volunteers. Monthly Happy Hours (on the last Friday of every month) are organised, and they are very well received. A Summer Camp is run for the children of our members who are taught abseiling, canoeing, watersports, archery, hiking, map reading, shooting, cooking and also some history of Hong Kong during the darker times of the Japanese occupation. An improved local website covering all aspects of welfare support – from financial advice, transport, to a job's noticeboard – will soon be active.

This new direction has brought a significant improvement to welfare, comradeship and the sense of belonging to our members. We are very pleased with the outcome and hope to further improve our support capabilities over the coming months.





RHEINDAHLEN BRANCH (District Germany)

”The Citation”

In North-West Europe on 23rd January, 1945 the leading section of a Royal Marine Commando Troop having come under intense machine-gun fire was ordered to make for some houses close by. Four of the section had been wounded and were left lying in the open. Under continuous fire Lance Corporal Harden at once went forward and with great coolness and bravery attended to the four casualties. He then carried one of them back to cover. He was ordered not to go forward again and an attempt was made to bring in the remaining casualties with the aid of tanks, but this proved unsuccessful owing to the heavy and accurate fire of anti-tank guns. A second attempt under a smoke-screen also proving unsuccessful, Lance Corporal Harden insisted in going forward with a volunteer stretcher party and succeeded in bringing back another badly wounded man. He went out a third time, and whilst returning with the stretcher party, he was killed. Throughout this long period Lance -Corporal Harden displayed superb devotion to duty and personal courage of the highest order. His action was directly responsible for saving the lives of the wounded brought in, while his complete contempt for all personal danger, and the magnificent example he set of cool courage and determination to continue with his work, whatever the odds, was an inspiration to his comrades and will never be forgotten by those who saw it

Above is the citation related to the Victoria Cross, awarded posthumously to LCpl Harden for his heroic behaviour.

The above events occurred on that fateful day of 1945 in the vicinity of the small town of Maasbracht in the Netherlands, South of Roermond. The town and the local school hold a short service every year at his memorial stone, even 74 years after the event.

The Rheindahlen Branch, RBL, located just on the other side of the German/Dutch border, provide backing to the service and lay a poppy-wreath in commemoration. Local school-children form the majority of the congregation so it is hoped that his memory will be honoured for many years to come. The service this year was on Monday, 21st January 2019.

The photographs below show the memorial stone and our member, Chris Farrell, reading the citation to the assembled





Berlin Branch- Germany

Eulogy to Bill Sheckleston OBE. 4 Jan 19. Brigadier Rob Rider CBE. Honorary President of RBL Berlin Branch and British Defence Attaché Berlin.

Ladies and Gentlemen,
It's an honour to be asked to say something on behalf of the British Embassy and as honorary President of the Royal British Legion Berlin Branch in memory of William Sheckleston OBE, or as we knew him, Bill Sheckleston, most pertinently as Bill helped form the Berlin Branch of the RBL in 1963 - of course in those days he had the GOC HQ Berlin (British Sector), a Major-General as President. Nowadays over 50 years later it is the Defence Attaché who is a Brigadier who has the honour to fulfil this role.
From our point of view - Bill was a very well-known, kind and honourable man and distinguished member of the British community here and member of the British Legion of which he was a founder member and later Vice President. This full church reflects the high regard in which he was held. Indeed he was a witness to St Georges Church, an Anglican Church being rebuilt here in West-end in 1950 – that's how much he belonged to this British community.
For Bill's family Thomas Sheckleston, the Ambassador also joins us in passing on his condolences to you all at this time.
Bill was of course awarded an OBE in 1991, to go with his earlier MBE for his work as the Vice-Consul of the British Embassy Office Berlin, so the Embassy is particularly grateful to have the honour to be represented here today.
It's worth reflecting on what Bill stood for from our perspective – the RBL and why it is there: to provide lifelong support for the Armed Forces community - serving men and women, veterans, and their families – and we are doing that to remember Bill Sheckleston today as that is what he did and we should take inspiration from his example.
It is particularly poignant to be here a few days after 2018 has passed, that is 100 years after the end of the First World War and the founding of the RBL in 1921 and the RBL played an important role in leading the Remembrance events in honour of that First World War generation.
Bill Sheckleston In his own words was called up at the pleasure of King George VI and was proud of his service in the army and arrived in Berlin shortly after the end of the Second World War in 1946. He particularly valued the comradeship he found in the Army which stood him in good stead all of his life and he found this comradeship also in the Legion.
He served in the Royal Engineers here in Berlin, and returned as a civilian in 1950, he work for the British Military Administration, and then as a consul, marrying a German girl. According to you and to him, he found Berlin a fascinating place, built bridges to the Anglo-German community and considered it his home.
Whilst we mourn his passing, we are honoured to have him on the RBL Berlin "Roll of Honour".
Bill of course was instrumental in forming this new version of the RBL Berlin in 1963 and served as its Hon Secretary for over 30 years.
I am also hugely grateful to Bill and members of the RBL for keeping in touch with Allied Veterans Associations such as the American Veterans and the French Veterans, and keeping in touch with the Bundeswehr and Berlin authorities of course in particular Spandau and Charlottenburg. As well as the German War Graves Commission and own Commonwealth Wargraves Commission, and 248 GSU. I am always delighted to see the RBL's standard bearers and wreaths at numerous ceremonies in Germany, and hear of your attendance representing the RBL and de facto the United Kingdom at events I or the other Attaches cannot attend. It was I believe for him, as it is for me, a sign of reconciliation with former enemies.
Bill also ensured that the RBL had a strong Anglo-German connection which is reflected in the current Berlin Branch membership.

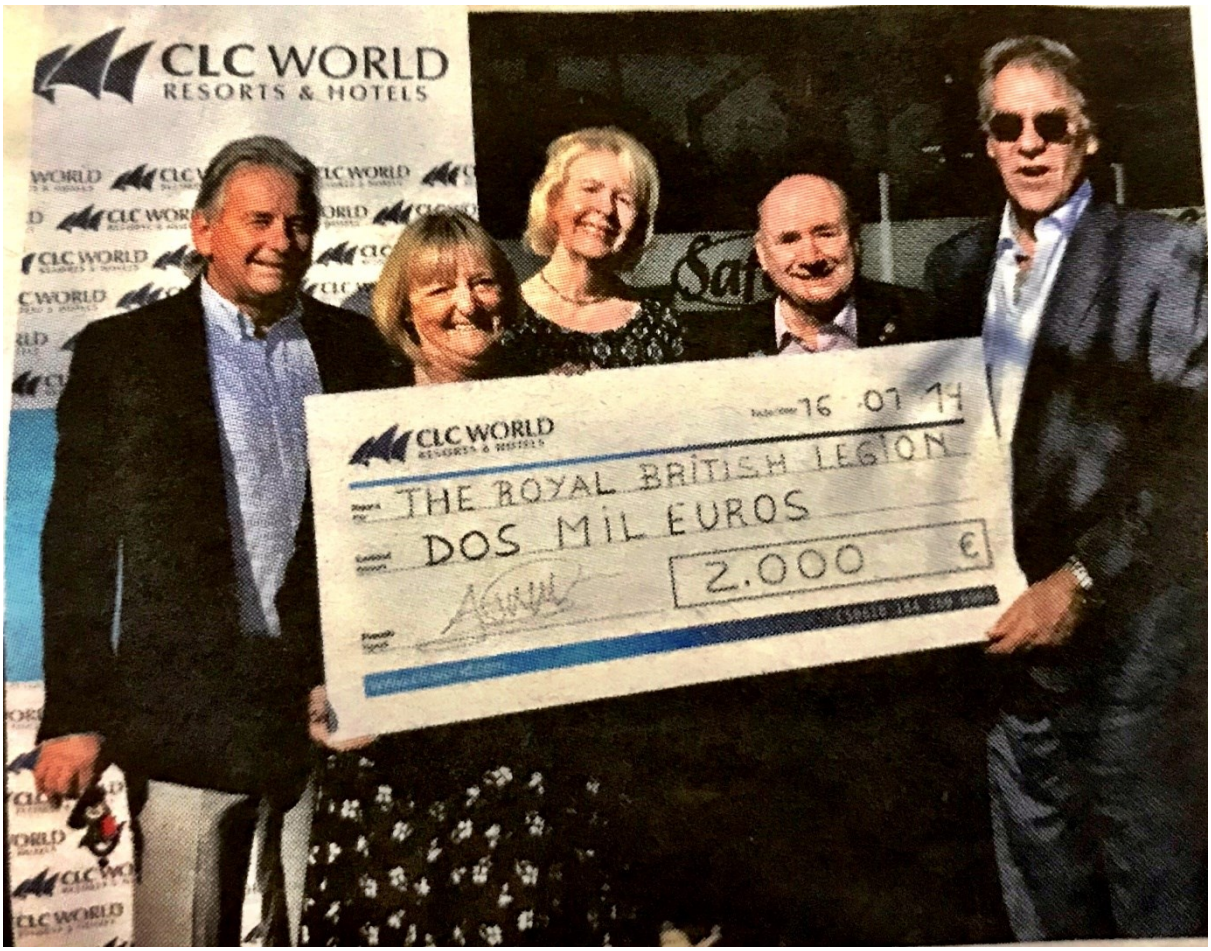
I think the following words of Sir Richard HOWARD-VYSE, a former president
"Without our principles we would be like a ship without a rudder in a storm . I do not believe that an organisation likes ours can retain its strength and vigour ndefinitely unless it has a strong spiritual background. Our motto is "Service not Self" must be taken to mean wider service to the community as a whole through exampleby word and deed, then the Legion can be a potential influence for good even the world over. To remember our duty by living up to our motto is the best possible way which we can ensure the continuing strength of the Legion".

Willliam Sheckleston, OBE lived these principles. We honour his service and memory.



MARBELLA BRANCH (Northern Spain)

' The Classic Car Club Andalucia (CCCA) held a special brunch at the La Sala restaurant at Puerto Banus , Spain to commemorate the 100 years since the end of the World War 1. They raised Euros 2000 for the Royal British Legion Marbella Branch . The cheque was presented in January to President Kathryn, Chairman Malcolm and Secretary Heather at Club La Costa World . This was only part of a considerable amount raised by Club La Costa World and La Sala Group in November as they also had a number of Poppy Boxes on their premises too. RBL Marbella thank them for the generous support and friendship.'



The picture shows Ian Giles (CCCA) Kathryn Pope (President Marbella RBL), Heather Lloyd (Secretary Marbella RBL) Malcolm Pope (Chairman Marbella RBL) Roy Peires (Chairman CLC World)

HONDÓN VALLEY BRANCH (Northern Spain)

Hondón Valley Legion Remember Robbie Burns.

When members and guests of the Hondón Valley Branch of The Royal British Legion sat down for their Burns' Night Supper, little did they know just what a great evening was planned. The venue was *El Nuevo Valle*, in Hondón de los Frailes and the MC for the evening was Ronnie Mannall. The piper, Tony Dolphin, did us proud and got us all in the Scottish spirit.

Ronnie recounted the life of Scotland's National Poet – Robert Burns and we then celebrated in a way Burns would have approved – eating, drinking, music, piping and poetry (and of course, the craic!) The haggis was piped in by Tony, which we toasted with a " wee dram " of whiskey, before tucking into Scotch broth , Haggis, Neeps and Tatties, steak pie, topping off the meal with Boozy Trifle, coffee and Scottish Butter Tablet. A number of members took part reading poems and the "Toast to the Lassies" by Joe Logan and "Response" by Carol were particularly entertaining. Following the meal Carol had prepared a super Scottish Quiz where members grouped into Clans. Tricky questions but very "educational" – for those Sassenachs among us! After the various toasts we all linked arms for Auld Lang Syne. A really enjoyable and memorable evening.







GRAN ALACANT BRANCH—District North Spain

The ZEST Bar/Restaurant in Gran Alacant, held a 40's night in November in aid of the Poppy Appeal.

Some guests even arrived with their gas mask boxes and appropriate style costumes.

After an excellent meal of garden vegetable soup, sausages and mash with onion gravy followed by apple pie with custard, there was a forties quiz, and a war-time singalong.

The evening raised €155, which was presented to Eric Goble, who at 97 is the second oldest member of the Gran Alacant & La Marina Branch.



Photos Credit with permission:

Gran Alacant Advertiser

On 8th November 2018, the 61st session of the Gran Alacant Oldies Walking Football club, took place at the GA Sports centre.

14 players took part plus one referee and one injured on the sidelines.

The club had previously decided by ballot to donate some funds to the Royal British Legion Poppy Appeal.The presentation was made by James, who suggested the idea.

There to receive the money were Robin Hargrave and Terry Lacey, who are respectively Chairman and Secretary of the Gran Alacant & La Marina Branch.



Photo Credit with permission:

Sandra Lane – GA Oldies Walking Football Club

GRAN ALACANT BRANCH—cont

RBL Thanks Overseas Supermercados

Last year, the management, staff and customers of the San Fulgencio branch of Overseas Supermercados (known locally as Iceland) raised a massive € 2,673 for the Poppy Appeal.

Helen Goodman, the Poppy Appeal Organiser for Gran Alacant & La Marina Branch, is seen presenting a Thank You Certificate to Store Manager Anthony Burton.

The Gran Alacant & La Marina Branch of the Royal British Legion meets on the first Monday of the month at 6pm in Lounge “D” , Plaza Mayor, Gran Alacant.

New members are always made most welcome, and remember you do NOT have to be ex- services to join the Legion.

If you or anyone you know, is in need of help or assistance from the Legion please telephone 676 451 780



JAVEA BRANCH - Spain North

Javea branch had a Car treasure Hunt from Javea to Nou Portet restaurant in Murla on 20th February .17 people took part with yours truly setting the course and a table top quiz.
We were blessed with beautiful weather and the course wound its way through a lot of the blossom in bloom at the moment in the Val de Pop.
Excellent food in a friendly environment, the only black mark on the day was our President Roger and his wife our treasurer won both the Treasure hunt AND the quiz!!!

Tony Edmunds ,Chairman Javea Branch.





MOJACAR BRANCH (Northern Spain)

MOJACAR BRANCH – EVENTS

The Branch enjoyed a wonderful evening at their annual Poppy Appeal Dinner Dance in October, this year held at The Continental Hotel in Mojacar. They were well entertained by Driftwood who were joined by friends singing WW1 songs for all to join in with dancing and singing. 818€ were raised.

As with the previous year, the Branch had a display table of poppies and poppy items in a local shopping centre/café-bar on the two Saturdays leading up to Remembrance Day. On the second Saturday, 10, the public were also entertained by Lady Ellen, a professional singer, who kindly gives her services free to support poppy appeal and the Branch. One favourite song is always, Bring "Them" Home, as from Les Miserables. The public were most appreciative and this encouraged them to donate.

This summer a local restaurant in Villiaricos, Los Conteros, chose to support Poppy Appeal through Mojacar Branch with their "Triple 11" collections, the aim being to achieve this figure by 11am on 11th day of 11th month, a figure they achieved and exceeded, finally achieving 2067.23€ Mojacar Branch thanks Lenka and Chris of the restaurant for this fantastic effort.

We have had a good year and look forward to a better one. There have been many well attended fund raising quizzes in addition to the social events and these are set to continue with other fund raising events involving local venues. In February we had a quiz with buffet in Miraflores Camp site which raised, with sponsorship from a local Insurance Company, Ibex, 545€. In April we are having a sponsored walk in Mojacar in conjunction with the Rose and Crown Pub. We then have again this year, a sponsored Golf Day at Aguilon Golf course in May.

We have a full programme of interesting speakers organised for the Branch Meetings and the second meetings of the month, coffee mornings in differing cafes on Mojacar Playa continue to be extremely popular bringing in more existing members and hopefully new members attracted by our presence.







PINOSO BRANCH (Southern Spain)

Constitution Day in Pinoso

As has been the custom during the last few years, in the days leading up to the Día de la Constitución on 6th December each year, the Ayuntamiento of Pinoso organised the reading and live broadcast of the Articles of the Spanish Constitution read by the leaders of various local groups and by invited members of the public.

2018 is the 40th anniversary of the acceptance in a referendum of the Spanish Constitution following the election the previous year of the first elected government since the 1920s.

This year the Pinoso branch of the RBL were honoured by the branch chairman, Colin Hindmarsh, being invited to read one of the articles, fittingly, "The Rights of Foreigners"

The event took place on 4th December in the recently constructed Centro Cultural, and following an introduction by the Alcalde in which he spoke of the progress achieved over the last 40 years, the invitees, some 50 in total, ranging from primary school children, teenagers, adults and senior citizens, followed the Alcalde in each reading an article of the constitution.

The Pinoso branch is very fortunate in having a very close working relationship with the towns Ayuntamiento, with councillors and the Alcalde taking part in, and providing the printing of the programmes for the annual Remembrance Day Service, and by keeping the Pinoso Branch and its members informed of forthcoming local events and celebrations organised by the Ayuntamiento and other organizations.





COIN BRANCH—District Spain South

ROYAL BRITISH LEGION COIN BRANCH 13th BIRTHDAY

Fifty-four members and guests of the Coin branch of the Royal British Legion gathered at 11am at La Parilla De Pepe on the 16th of January to celebrate the branch's 13th birthday. To mark the occasion, Jean Merry (left) baked a fantastic fruit cake and Rosie Mahoney (centre) used her extensive icing skills to produce a culinary delight that both looked good and tasted delicious. In accordance with tradition, Chairman Jo Taylor (right) cut the cake for everyone to taste and auctioned a big piece for the poppy appeal.

After wishing the Branch a happy birthday and leading a round of applause, Jo Taylor told the story of January 2006 when 6 people formed the Coin branch and curiosity got the better of 46 people who turned up to see what this new venture of the Royal British Legion in Spain looked like. They must have been impressed because the branch membership in January 2019 stands at 134



BUMPER YEAR for COIN POPPY APPEAL

A sponsored cycle ride by Coin RBL member Ray Bower and his friend John Staton raised 2,150 euros for the Royal British Legion 2018 Poppy Appeal. This amazing achievement brings the year-end total for 2018 to a colossal 13,747 euros. Poppy Appeal Organiser George Chaney and his wife Marion wish to thank Ray and John as well as all the members and friends of the Coin branch for their help and support throughout the year.



MOLLINA BRANCH (Southern Spain)

FLORES FUNDRAISERS KICK STARTS COMMUNIITY PROJECT





On Saturday 8th December 8o members and friends enjoyed a fantastic buffet at Bar Flores in Mollina where a quiz hosted by Mike and Carol Foggin and a raffle raised over €320 toward the cost of the RBL Community support Programme due to start in the new year

On Monday17 December when the bar would normally be closed Mine Hosts Vic and Mandy Davies organised a Xmas Fayre in aid of the RBL and Girasol a local care organisation supporting the terminally ill.





David Grey events organiser thanking Vic and Mandy for organising the two events said that the timing of the event was particularly appropriate as the two organisations were currently exploring a strategic partnership to enhance the effectiveness of both organisations.(the day raised another €160) for the RBL project)

Vic said "Mandy and I are delighted to support both organisations whose volunteers do so much for the local communities around Mollina our adoptive home.

Photos by David Grey

MOLINA cont



On 12 February, Chairman Austin Tansley presented newly installed President Colin Lamb with his badge of office and a certificate of Merit to Chris Roddis.
Chris, one of the branch founder members is leaving to return to the UK following the death of his wife last year.
Colin, who served in the RAF was previously Branch Standard Bearer before being forced to retire due to ill health.
Colin was born in Sussex UK in 1951, joined the Royal Air Force in 1969 and completed 22 years serving at several UK and overseas bases. He left the RAF in 1991 as a Senior Non Commissioned Officer and then joined British Aerospace in a training role to train the Royal Saudi Air Force in Dhahran in the eastern province and finally retired in 2013 returning to Europe then settling here in Spain.

Colin joined the Mollina branch of TRBL and took up the standard Bearer role and handed this over after 3 years

---

This newsletter is produced on a quarterly basis on the following dates in 2019:

Monday, 3rd June - article deadline May 27th 2019

Monday, 2nd September—article deadline August 26th 2019

Please send any news items in Word format only to email address:
overseassupport@britishlegion.org.uk
